Prize Description

MEBC 2026

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1. Introduction

This document serves as a comprehensive guide to understanding and describing the prizes offered by the **Yacht Club de Monaco** as the organiser of the **Monaco Energy Boat Challenge**. Our commitment to fostering innovation, creativity, and excellence is reflected in these prizes, which aim to recognise and reward outstanding and future-oriented projects related to the yachting and maritime industry.

This documentation is fully in accordance with the Notice of Challenge published on the official website and should be considered as an extension for further clarification. **All university teams are required to submit at least one, well-prepared prize application to fulfil the requirements outlined in the Notice of Challenge.**

Submissions of unacceptable quality may indicate non-compliance with the rules.

A presentation template will be available among the official documentations.

One team may apply for one, two or all the prizes without any limitations.

For those who participate in more prizes, the points will be accumulated for the "Monaco Energy Boat Challenge Champion". Applying for all prizes therefore aids in maximising the potential points for this title.

Submission & Deadlines

The required documentations or materials for each prize must be uploaded on the Team's Dashboard. **The Team name and the name of the prize should be indicated in the name of the uploaded files. E.g. XX Team_Innovation Prize**

The deadline applicable is stated in the Notice of Challenge. **1st of June 2026.**

No changes will be allowed to the documentations or materials after the submission deadline.

Selection of the Finalists and Tech Talk Format

At submission closure, the International Jury will perform an in-depth assessment of the materials provided.

For each prize, the best 4 or 5 submissions will be selected as finalists. The finalists will be announced by the **31st of June 2026**.

The finalists will present their submission in front of the International Jury as part of the Tech Talks in Monaco.

For each prize, the presentation time must not exceed 10 minutes which is followed by a 5-minute-long Q&A session.

2. Innovation Prize

2.1 General Description

This prestigious award recognises and honours the team that demonstrated exceptional innovation in its project. We are on the look-out for ideas that not only push the boundaries of what is possible but also have the potential to make a lasting impact on the future of yachting.

2.2 Submission Format

A valid submission comprises of two elements:

- A Video:

The teams are required to submit a maximum 2-minute-long pitch video that effectively showcases their innovation. The pitch videos might be shared on the official website of the event by the Event Communications department.

- Documentation:

The final Tech Talk presentation with detailed information about the innovation. The presentation should be technical and comprise all the necessary elements to make a proper technical evaluation possible.

2.3 Assessment Criteria

1. **Novelty and Uniqueness:** Evaluation of the idea's novelty and uniqueness. How does it differ from existing solutions or approaches?
2. **Problem Solving and Value Creation:** The assessment of how well the idea addresses a specific problem or challenge. The more effectively and efficiently it solves a real-world issue, the higher its innovative potential is. In addition, the innovation should demonstrate clear value creation for society.
3. **Market Potential:** The consideration of the idea's market viability and potential impact. Does it have the potential to meet market needs or create a new market altogether?
4. **Feasibility:** Evaluate the practicality and feasibility of implementing the idea. Consider technical, financial, and logistical aspects to ensure it is realistic.
5. **Scalability:** The assessment of the scalability of the idea. Can it be easily scaled up or adapted to different markets and contexts?
6. **Proof of Concept:** Evidence of a well-developed proof of concept. The innovation is installed and running on the boat participating in the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.

3. Design Prize

3.1 General Description

This prestigious award recognises outstanding boat designs that not only demonstrate engineering excellence but also captivate with their aesthetic brilliance.

3.2 Submission Format

The teams are required to submit a poster consisting of three-pages of A3 in horizontal format as per 3.4.

The finalist works will be exhibited in the Yacht Club de Monaco during the event as part of the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge- Design Exhibition.

- **Documentation:**

The final Tech Talk presentation should provide detailed information on the design. It must be design-oriented and include all necessary elements to enable a proper evaluation, such as the design inspiration, key design phases, and a demonstration of how the project meets the criteria outlined below.

3.3 Assessment Criteria

1. **Global Design Approach:** This criterion focuses on evaluating the overall methodologies employed in designing the boat; considering its comprehensiveness and adaptability across diverse contexts, like technological integration and efficiency.
2. **Sustainable Design Approach:** The design concentrates on solutions that prioritise minimising environmental impact, conserving resources, and ensuring the long-term sustainability. Moreover, the design emphasises a conscientious design process that aims to mitigate harm to the environment, whilst promoting a harmonious relationship between human activities and the ecosystem.
3. **Human Interface and Ergonomics:** The assessment of the clarity and efficiency of the user-interface, as well as ensuring that ergonomic considerations are integrated to minimise physical strain and enhance overall user comfort during interaction.
4. **Out-of-the-Box Thinking and Originality:** The assessment of the creative thinking and uniqueness embedded in the design, emphasising the ability to break away from conventional solutions and introduce novel, imaginative elements to address challenges or requirements.
5. **Origin of Idea and Link with the Purpose and Environment:** This criterion assesses how well the design reflects a clear and purposeful connection between the initial concept and the ultimate goals or objectives; ensuring that the design remains purpose-driven and effectively addresses the intended needs or challenges. The design emphasises the clarity of the idea's origin and its alignment not only with the intended purpose but also with environmental considerations.
6. **Aesthetics:** The evaluation of the visual and sensory aspects of a design, focusing on its beauty, harmony, and overall appeal. This criterion assesses the form, colour, texture, and other design elements to determine how well they come together to create an aesthetically pleasing and cohesive outcome.

3.4 Poster Design Guidelines

Teams are expected to convey their concept primarily through visual means, such as hand drawings and/or 3D renderings. Illustrate how your approach addresses the assessment criteria. Furthermore, a minimum of font size 14 is required (people should be able to read all the information from a distance of 1 metre).

1st Page – Main presentation of the concept and overall views with title and text.

2nd Page – Detailed principle/focus showing functionality / ergonomics / ...

3rd Page – Concept explanation (could integrate images if needed).

4. Eco-Conception Prize

4.1 General Description

The Eco-Conception Prize is a distinguished recognition that places a spotlight on sustainability and environmental responsibility. This award honours initiatives that prioritise eco-conscious design by integrating comprehensive Life Cycle Assessments. By evaluating a product or project from its conception to disposal, the Eco-Conception Prize aims to recognise and promote projects that minimise environmental impact across their entire life cycle. More detailed guidance can be found in the document "MarineShift360_2026_Eco-Conception-Prize-Guidelines" among the official documents.

4.2 Assessment Criteria

Please refer to "2026_Eco-Conception_Prize_Scoring_Criteria" for the assessment criteria.

4.3 Submission Format

The finalists will present their results at the Tech Talks.

- A MarineShift360 Report:

All teams entering the Eco-Conception Prize must complete a cradle-to-grave Life Cycle Assessment (LCA) of their vessel. Teams must then submit a Life Cycle Assessment Sustainability Report following the official Eco-Conception Prize Report Template.

- Documentation:

The Final Tech Talk Presentation, composed of a 10-minute presentation and allowed time of 5 minutes for Q&A, with detailed information about the Eco-Conception Prize. The presentation should describe:

  - One clear compelling eco-design insight from the team's LCA in a way that is credible, impactful, and accessible to both technical and non-technical jurors.
  - Can focus on insights from key learnings, innovations, design choices, or production decisions, but it must be backed by data and clearly linked to the teams Life Cycle Assessment results.